

Charles E. Ross

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior software developer and solution architect with more than 20 years of experience building custom CRM, workflow automation, and line-of-business applications for specialized business teams. Recent work includes AI-assisted development of a custom CRM for a mortgage broker using Claude Code, alongside projects delivered with Salesforce, OutSystems, FileMaker, Python, and modern web stacks. Comfortable owning architecture, implementation, deployment, integration, and client-facing technical communication for either contract or permanent roles.

CORE SKILLS

- AI-assisted development: Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Replit Agent
- CRM and business systems: custom CRM, workflow automation, Salesforce Lightning Platform, FileMaker, OutSystems
- Application development: JavaScript, Python, Flask, PHP, HTML, CSS, Lightning Web Components, Apex
- Data and integration: PostgreSQL, MySQL, SOQL, JSON, XML, XSLT, REST API integrations
- Platforms and delivery: web, macOS, Windows, iOS, FileMaker Server, Linux web servers, Heroku
- Additional background: AppleScript, Cocoa, Objective-C++, Xojo, UI/UX design

EXPERIENCE

Developer & Proprietor, Chivalry Software | 2004-Present

- Build custom CRM, operations, and workflow applications for clients in mortgage brokerage, legal, publishing, education, retail, entertainment, and manufacturing.
- During the last year, used Claude Code to help build a custom CRM for a mortgage broker, rapidly implementing business-specific workflows and application features in an actively evolving product.
- Built or contributed to business systems across multiple stacks, including React, Node.js, PostgreSQL, Salesforce Lightning Platform, OutSystems, FileMaker, Flask, and CakePHP.
- Served as lead developer, DevOps owner, and application architect for Salesforce-based CRM work, including an AppExchange administrator utility for managing complex permission sets.
- Delivered internal tools spanning recruiting, employee assessment, support ticketing, surveys, inventory, project tracking, invoicing, accounting conversion, and field incident reporting.
- Guide platform selection, systems design, deployment, and ongoing maintenance for client environments, including FileMaker Server, Salesforce orgs, Linux web servers, and Heroku.

Selected Projects

- **Mortgage Brokerage CRM** (2025–2026): Senior developer on a full-stack custom CRM built from scratch for a live mortgage brokerage. Delivered loan pipeline management, document collection, client communication tracking, and reporting using React, Node.js, and PostgreSQL. Used AI-assisted development with Claude Code and Replit Agent throughout the engagement.
- **Business Operations Platform** (2021–2025): Lead developer and architect for a multi-module Salesforce-based platform used across HR, recruiting, project tracking, surveys, support ticketing, and field incident reporting. Owned architecture, DevOps, data model, and client-facing technical communication across four years of continuous delivery.
- **Salesforce Permission Assistant** (2023–2024): Senior contributor on an AppExchange utility that simplified management of complex Salesforce permission sets for enterprise-scale orgs.

- **lwc-popover-window** (2023–2024, open source): Authored a reusable Lightning Web Component enabling popover windows in Salesforce Lightning Experience. Published as open source and documented in a technical article.

Writer / Editor, Various Publications | 2000-Present

- Write and edit technical content focused on FileMaker, Salesforce, AppleScript, and software development.
- Served as technical editor for Xcode 5: Start to Finish and contributed two chapters to The Book of FileMaker.
- Published tutorials, reviews, and technical articles for Macworld Magazine, ISO FileMaker Magazine, and About This Particular Macintosh.

Manager of Software Development, Bert Howe and Associates | 2007-2008

- Developed in-house applications supporting litigation workflow and operations.
- Supported existing systems and advised on technical direction.

Manager of Information Systems, JobElephant.com | 2006-2007

- Built and maintained internal business operations software and vendor data exchanges.
- Administered internal macOS-based infrastructure and provided employee support and training.

Earlier Experience

- Developer, Productive Computing | 2003-2004
- Senior Developer, Metro Technologies | 2000-2003
- Manager of Information Systems / Database Analyst, Direct Partners | 1996-1999
- Manager of Information Technologies, Grey Advertising | 1993-1996

OPEN SOURCE AND COMMUNITY

- Created lwc-popover-window, structured-flask, alexandria, and filemaker.vim.
- Maintained or contributed to FMEasyAudit, Flask, Werkzeug, Flask-Bcrypt, Flask-Dotenv, Vim, SimpleImage, and UltiSnips.
- Mentor on Python and JavaScript tracks at Exercism.
- Top 10% Stack Overflow user and longtime moderator on FMForums.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

- University of California, Los Angeles | Mathematics with Specialization in Computing
- Certified FileMaker Developer
- Salesforce Superbadges: Apex Specialist, Lightning Experience Specialist, Security Specialist, App Customization Specialist
- Additional training: Python, JavaScript, Responsive Web Design, Bash shell scripting, Docker and Kubernetes